Aritra Basu

Department of Economics, University of Massachusetts Amherst
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Education

2021–Present **Ph.D. candidate in Economics**, University of Massachusetts Amherst
Expected 2027
Dissertation committee: James Heintz (Chair), Nancy Folbre, Christopher Boone, Joya Misra

2023 **M.A. in Economics**, University of Massachusetts Amherst

2019–2021 **Graduate coursework in Economics**, McGill University

2017–2019 **M.A. in Economics**, Ambedkar University Delhi

2013–2016 **B.A. in Economics**, Jadavpur University

Research Fields

Identity and Inequality; Labor Economics; Development Economics

Job Market Paper

Crossing the Color Line: Race, Place, and Deaths of Despair

Did the Great Migration and its consequences matter for later mortality? This paper shows that the mortality effects due to the rise in Chinese import competition in the early 21st century were mediated by the racial history of the most affected communities. In particular, the Great Migration of Blacks to Northern industrial cities between the 1940s and 1970s rendered those destinations with the highest migration flows more segregated and more vulnerable to economic shocks, resulting in higher levels of "deaths of despair" among both White and Black men. My findings show that the spatial vulnerabilities were not limited to Black communities, and they also challenge the conventional emphasis on "deaths of despair" among White men.

Publications

Basu, Aritra, and Nancy Folbre. 2026. "Employment in Childcare and Early Education in the United States, 2000–23." *Monthly Labor Review*, July.
doi:10.21916/mlr.2026.19

Working Papers

Before Love Jihad: Communal Violence and Religious Intermarriages in India
Under review at *Feminist Economics*.

Are All Low-Wage Workers Alike? Heterogeneity in the Post-Pandemic U.S. Labor Market
With Caterina Manicardi and Anamika Sen.

Work in Progress

Redirecting Intergroup Antagonism: Caste Networks, Hindu Nationalism, and the Evolution of Hate Crimes in India
Dissertation chapter.

What Money Can't Buy: Gender and Substitutability between Income and Unpaid Work in the U.S.
With Nancy Folbre.

Teaching Experience

Instructor, University of Massachusetts Amherst

Fall 2026	ECON 337: Economics in the Age of Big Data (current)
Winter 2026	ECON 104: Introduction to Macroeconomics

Teaching Assistant, University of Massachusetts Amherst

Sept. 2021–May 2022	
Spring 2022	ECON 104: Introduction to Macroeconomics
Fall 2021	ECON 103: Introduction to Microeconomics

Research Experience

Sept. 2022–Summer 2026 **Research Assistant to Professor Nancy Folbre**
Political Economy Research Institute, University of Massachusetts Amherst

Conference Presentations

Feb. 27, 2026 John Jay–New School Conference on Contemporary Political Economy, New York, NY
Revising Deaths of Despair: Racial Residential Segregation and the Unequal Toll of the China Shock

Jan. 3, 2026 ASSA Annual Meeting, Association for Social Economics session, Philadelphia, PA
Race Shocks: Manufacturing Declines and Residential Segregation

July 5, 2025 33rd IAFFE Annual Conference, University of Massachusetts Amherst, Amherst, MA
Before Love Jihad: Communal Violence and Religious Intermarriages in India

Mar. 1, 2024 50th Eastern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Boston, MA
Law and Social Reproduction in Assam's Tea Plantations: 1859–1901

2023 John Jay College, Law and Political Economy, New York, NY
Law and Social Reproduction in Assam's Tea Plantations: 1859–1901

Referee Service

Feminist Economics; *American Sociological Review*

Awards and Fellowships

2025 **PERI Barnard Family Fellowship**
Political Economy Research Institute, University of Massachusetts Amherst

2017–2019 **Academic Merit Scholarships**, Ambedkar University Delhi
M.A. Fall and Winter semesters, 2017–2018 and 2018–2019

2016 **Silver Medal for Ranking Second in B.A.**, Jadavpur University

Skills and Languages

Software	Stata (proficient); R (proficient)
Languages	Bengali (native); Hindi (fluent); English (fluent)

References

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University of Massachusetts
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Christopher Boone
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